

L1.1 — Fractions: Meaning, Equivalence, Comparison

Cuemath Academy · Math Kangaroo Foundations Grade 5–6

■ Read a fraction The bottom number tells you how many equal parts the whole is split into. The top number tells you how many of those parts you have. 3/5 Whole split into 5 equal parts, 3 of them shaded → 3/5	X■ Fraction of a group To find a/b of N, split N into b equal groups, then take a of them. Works for shapes, sets of objects, or any quantity. 2/3 of 12 = 12/3 × 2 = 8 2/3 of 12 = (12 ÷ 3) × 2 = 8
✂■ Build equivalents Multiply top AND bottom by the same number — the value stays the same, only the name changes. 1/2 = 1 × 3/2 × 3 = 3/6 1/2 = 3/6 (×3 on top and bottom)	■■ Compare fractions Rewrite with a common denominator, then compare the tops. Or use benchmarks: is it near 0, near 1/2, or near 1? 2/3 vs 3/5: \ 10/15 > 9/15 2/3 vs 3/5 → 10/15 vs 9/15, so 2/3 is bigger
■ Find the whole If you know what one part is worth, divide to find one share, then multiply up to the full whole. 3/4 = 18 \ → \ 1/4=6 \ → \ whole=24 If 3/4 of something is 18, then 1/4 = 6, so the whole is 24	■ Fractions describe quantities A fraction isn't just a number — it's a description of a part compared to a whole. Always ask: what IS the whole here? 2/3 of a pizza 2/3 of a class 2/3 of a pizza and 2/3 of a class are different amounts — same fraction, different wholes